



IDEA9106 Design Thinking

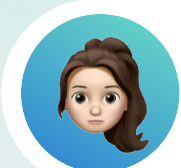
Human-Centred Research Report

How might we increase  job availability
for  disabled people in Australia
during the high inflation period
from a  multicultural perspective?

ultraHD group



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“ This research aims to provide insights and recommendations on how might we reduce the cost of living pressures for people with disabilities in Australia from a multicultural perspective.”

The cost of living in Australia has soared significantly in recent years, placing heavy financial pressure on numerous households. Meanwhile, COVID-19 is sweeping across the globe, leaving a trail of suffering in its wake. As patients struggle with the long-term effects of the disease, the world is grappling with a host of aftermaths. The pandemic has spawned a horrible storm of skyrocketing housing prices, soaring energy costs, and a warming planet, all of which have converged to create an **era of high inflation**. For people with disabilities (PWD), who often face **additional expenses** and **limited workforce** related to their disability, the cost of living pressures can be especially challenging.

The design brief outlined the challenges that negatively impact people’s quality of life and well-being due to the rising cost of living. These effects can be felt disproportionately by those with limited financial resources. This research focuses on finding ways to address this issue, particularly the **job availability** for disabled people, who are a specific and vulnerable population. The primary objective

is to identify the root causes of the financial burden faced by disabled people in Australia and propose possible solutions.

To achieve our research objectives, we conducted primary and secondary research, including interviews with PWD, organizations, experts in the field, and the general public. We analyzed common themes and patterns from the interview, and consulted reports and publications to gain a deeper understanding of the **status quo** and existing solutions, so as to **develop ideated solutions** that meet the specific needs of PWD. We also try to take the approach to investigate from a **multicultural perspective**, given the diversity of Australia’s population.

Overall, this research aims to provide insights and recommendations on how might we reduce the cost of living pressures for PWD in Australia from a multicultural perspective, enabling them to live fulfilling lives and thrive despite the financial challenges they face.

Project Overview



Macro Context
High inflation



Target Audience
Disability in AU



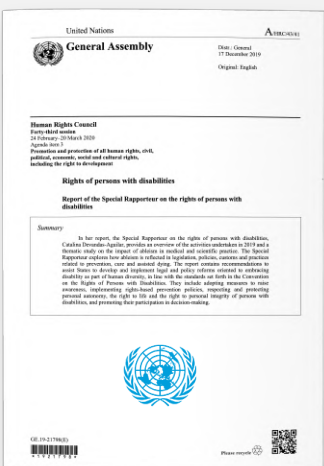
Research Aspect
Employment



Perspective
Multicultural



For a comprehensive understanding of Australia’s current economic and social environment and the challenges faced by people with disabilities, we conducted secondary research incorporating  statistical data,  news,  reports, and  academic papers. This background research focused on scanning the cost of living, employment, disability, and diversity issues and solutions in AU.





INFLATION

Highest CPI growth since 2000





UNEMPLOYED

Unemployment rate of working-age PWD are **2x higher** than those without disability



Hotly discussed topics like climate change, the shifting political and economic landscape and the carryover effects of pandemics have had a significant impact on the **cost of living** in Australia (McDonald, 2022; Fry et al., 2022). In 2022, the Consumer Price Index in Australia rose by 5.1%, marking the highest annual increase in the past two decades (McDonald, 2022). **COVID-19** resulted in an increase in both inflation and unemployment rates, meanwhile generating some job opportunities for the post-pandemic world (Australian Bureau of Statistics [ABS], 2023; Kelly, 2021).

Typically, having a job is one of the ways for most families to alleviate the financial pressure caused by inflation. But for PWD, having a job is not an easy task—disabled individuals in their working age are twice as likely to be unemployed

compared to non-disabled individuals (Australian Institute of Health and Welfare [AIHW], 2022). It cannot be ignored that the percentage of PWD in Australia is not low, with nearly one in five people in Australia has a disability (ABS, 2018), higher than the global average of 15% (World Health Organization, 2023). Those **disabled people often face barriers to employment**, including negative stereotypes, lack of public awareness, and discrimination. Almost one-fifth of the young disabilities experienced discrimination by employers and others when seeking employment (Australian Network on Disability [AND], n.d.). Ableism has also contributed to social prejudice among the public due to the **low awareness** of the various types of disability and the right perspective, exacerbating the potential discrimination from employers and colleagues in the workplace (United Nations Human Rights, 2019).

18%

People in AU has a disability





1/5 young disabled job-seekers experienced

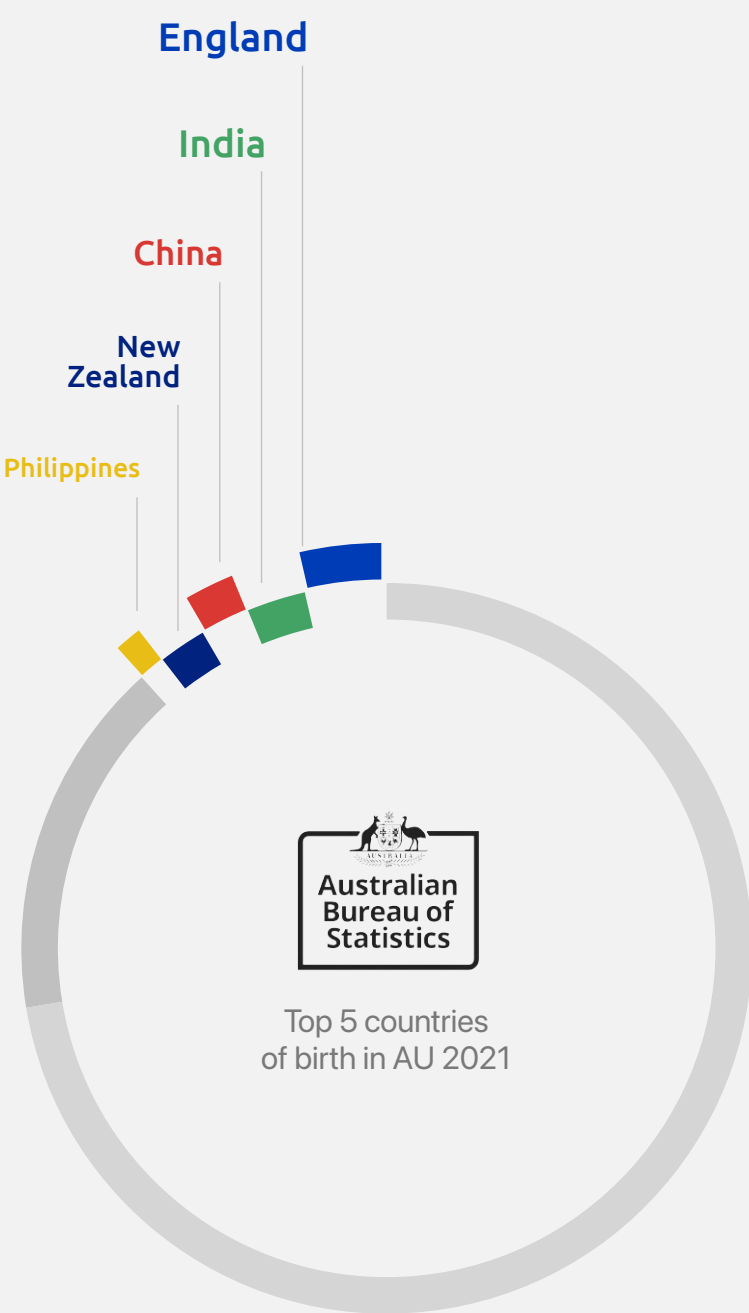
DISCRIMINATION

Background Research



27.6%

people in AU from overseas



Diversity is an unavoidable topic when investigating the demographics of Australia. The cultural and ethnic diversity is reflected in its population, with more than a quarter of its residents being born overseas (ABS, 2022). While China, a country with a strong East Asian culture, has surpassed the U.K. to be the primary source of permanent migrants to Australia, bringing a wide range vibrant cultural traditions and customs together with other countries all over the world (ABS, 2021; Phillips & Simon-Davies, 2017). In a country with such a diversity of population and abilities, the convergence of differences has led to numerous challenges in the face of the ever-changing global landscape.

Several scholars took the approach on researching disability in **multicultural** theories. Anastasiou et al. (2016) analyzed social justice issues including employment by treating disability as part of cultural diversity, while Selden, S. C. and Selden, F. (2001) also allocated disability into multiculturalism to investigate the diversity of social structures. However, **very little literature** examined the employment of PWD under such a complex social structure as Australia, and most of the existing articles were published before the pandemic widely affected people’s work habits and the rise of mobile Internet that created new employment patterns. Similarly, in addition to academics, Australian Institute of Health and Welfare also has pointed out that there is a **data gap** among disabled people with multilingual background.



LACK OF NEW LITERATURE



HIGH
Cost of living



HIGH
Disability rate



HIGH
Cultural diversity



LOW
PWD Employment rate



LOW
Comprehensive & new research

Therefore, there is a need to explore the factors that facilitate or hinder employment opportunities for disabled people during the high inflation period in the Post-COVID-19 Era, and how they vary across different disability groups of Australia.





🏛️ Government, 💼 companies, and 🏢 organizations all over the world have taken initiatives attempting to address the cost of living pressure of PWD, specifically their finance, employment, and discrimination issues.

They usually advertise and promote on platforms such as TV, radio, Internet and social media to inform the public about disability assistance policies and services. They also work with the community and media press.

“Apple don’t care.”

ROBERT SHAW

Former Apple disabled employee

“If you’re not eligible for the NDIS, you get virtually nothing.”

BRUCE BONYHADY

Architect of the NDIS scheme

“I left because their values of welfare and care were rubbish.”

A DISABILITY SUPPORT WORKER

Former Disability Services Australia staff



National Disability Insurance Scheme

Run by AU gov. that provides **fundings** for PWD to improve their quality of life.

It has been criticized for the **complex application**, too much **unnecessary expenses**, and its failure to solve the underlying problem as the biggest disability support program by government.

(National Disability Insurance Agency, 2022; Burton, 2022)



Disability Employment Services

An Australian gov. program that provides support to PWD to seek a stable job.

Now it is criticized for being **too focused on finding jobs** for disabled people rather than assisting with long-term career development that suits their individuality.

(Department of Social Services, 2023)



Technical and Further Education

Australia provides TAFE for disabled people to develop their occupation education. It provides necessary **capacities** and **confidence** for PWD to find a job in the future.



(TAFE NSW, n.d.)

Diversity & Inclusion Plans by Companies

Large enterprises now paid more attention on the rights of PWD, providing many job opportunities for people with disabilities that match their abilities.

Some giants like 🍏 Apple are still criticized by their own disabled employees that they might **not actually accommodate** flexibility with work schedule for PWD regarding their capacities, as well as accessibility facilities at workplaces.

(Australia Post, n.d.; Apple, n.d.; Tech Advisor, 2014; Kasana, 2019)

Disability Services Organizations

Many disability services organizations were founded to provide **various support** for PWD, such as helping them find a job, protecting their rights, and fulfilling their daily needs.

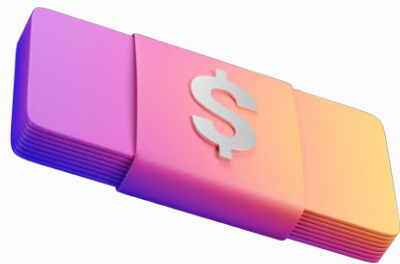
Some of their staff and the public criticized those organizations for too focused on money to actually care about disabled people, even become a **money grab**.

(Australia Post, n.d.; Apple, n.d.; Tech Advisor, 2014; Kasana, 2019)



Based on the secondary research, we found that Australia is a high-welfare country with a large number of people with disabilities, and the government has many programs to help them with their daily lives and employment. Combining statistics and reports, we generate the following assumptions:

It's **hard to find a job** for people with disabilities than those who without disabilities in AU.



The combined assistance from the government and various organizations **supports disabled people well.**

Cultural and linguistic barriers could be a challenge for people with disabilities in AU from other countries.



People with disabilities in AU still suffer from **discriminations.**

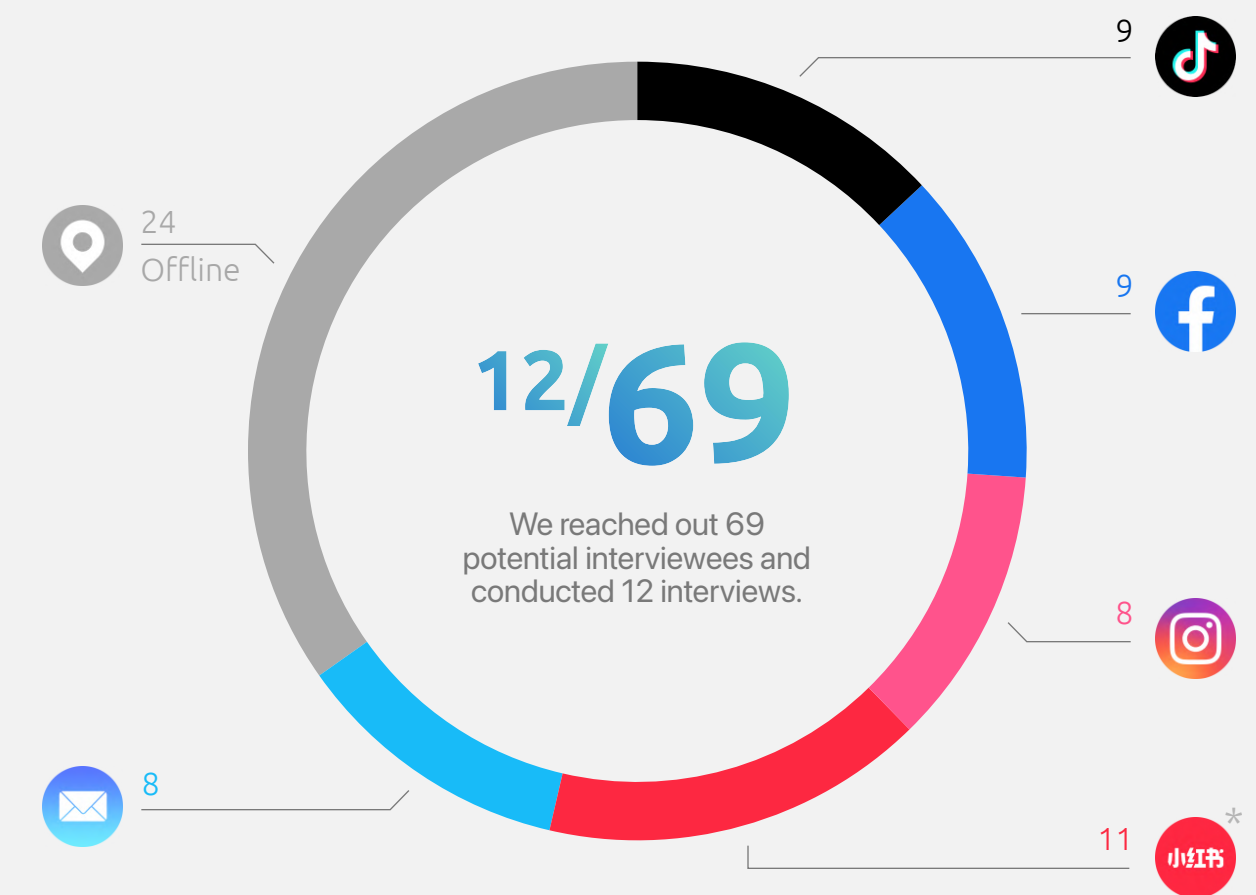
Interview · Data Collection

→ See consent letter in [Appendix A](#) (P19)



We attempted to reach out to people with disabilities through both  offline and  online methods. We conducted street interviews, visited and sent enquiry emails to disability service organizations and companies with disabled staff, and explored on multiple social media platforms.

We initially planed **face-to-face** interviews but found it difficult to locate intended interviewees within the disabled community who were often wary of strangers. We also received **nearly no response from organizations** and companies. Thus, we eventually conducted online interviews with a diverse group of individuals, recruited via **social media platforms** and **personal networks**. Limited participation from some individuals with disabilities was addressed through the use of accessible interview methods and obtaining informed consent. Caregivers, lawyers, and ordinary individuals were also interviewed to perceive the insights from the general public.



Online inquiry
via email &
social media DM



Face-to-face
Text interview
Zoom meeting
Phone call

We generated interview transcripts of 12,229 words.



* Xiaohongshu (Little Red Book) is a social media platform in China.

Interview • Willing Participants

→ See transcripts in [Appendix B](#) (P20-38)

People With Disabilities



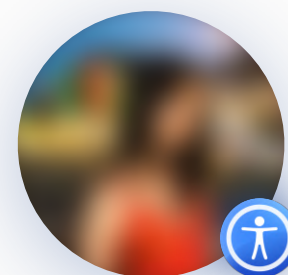
Dr Dinesh Palipana

Aussie of the Year 2021
Order of Australia recipient



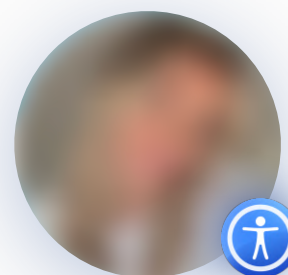
Colin

Surfing enthusiast
Rare disease patient



Tourettes Patient

TikTok influencer



Gastroparesis Patient

TikTok influencer
62.6K followers

Disability Allies



Chairperson

Australian Chinese
Community
Association



Senior Official

China Disabled
Persons' Federation;
Mobility impairments



Caregiver

Disability
center worker



Nursing Student

RMIT
University



Saudi

with a disabled
family member



Admin

USYD Disabilities
Collective

General Public



Alan Zhang

Principal Solicitor
VISIONLEGAL



Auntie Coco

High school teacher
in Sydney



Grace

High school student
in Sydney



Joe

PhD at USYD

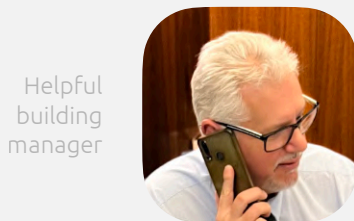
* Gastroparesis Patient was unable to participate at the last minute due to health reasons; Admin was unable to participate due to schedule.

“Hi 🙋 We’re the students at the University of Sydney. We are currently conducting a project focus on increasing the job availability for people with disabilities to improve their quality of life. Are you available for a brief anonymous interview now or when you are out of work?”

“No. I’m busy.”



Disability Support Services is ahead on the right.



Let me check... We don’t have this organization in this building.



Thank you for you email. The best place to contact to get help with you research project would be the Apple Accessibility team through this website: <https://support.apple.com/en-au/HT209585>

Good luck on your studies!

Regards,
Apple Sydney

This project’s challenges seem to have been destined from the moment we chose people with disabilities as our target audience.

We used to see disabled people on buses, trains, and on the streets, but when we walked out on a sunny afternoon ready to conduct street interviews, we only encountered one disabled person who refused to be interviewed for the whole afternoon. **They are sensitive.**

We visited the front desk of The Inclusion and Disability Services of USYD to inquire about speaking with some staff in their leisure time, and the receptionist kindly told us to send an [email](#). We did, but it seemed to disappear into thin air.

We visited Apple Broadway and Apple Sydney, communicating with kind-faced staff to request their help in connecting us with disabled employees for interviews when they get off work. The Apple Genius kindly told us to send an [email](#). We did, and surprisingly, Apple replied. However, it seemed they weren’t eager to have their employees be interviewed.

We searched for disability service centers on Google Maps. Some were **permanently closed**, and some were **nowhere to be found**. Contacting staff via [email](#) or phone was almost always rejected or ignored.

Offline interviews were nearly impossible, so we turned to online approach on Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, and Xiaohongshu. We sent private messages, joined group chats, and browsed group posts to reach more potential participants. **Unread, read but not replied, and rejections were the common.** Most of time, we did further communication via [email](#).

Disabled people often face more **health issues** than ordinary people, which also caused some people who had agreed to be interviewed to back out at the last minute.

But fortunately, our interviews eventually gathered valuable information.

Stay tuned for the next page.

Interview · Affinity Map

→ See the full map in [Miro](#)



Interview



INCLUSIVITY &
DISCRIMINATION

An inclusive workplace is essential for people with disabilities, in which Australia is friendly to those with physical impairments. However, people with disabilities in Australia are still facing **discrimination and ableism**, and the **public awareness** and education are needed to promote inclusivity. Inclusive issues also exist in obtaining government support for **multicultural groups**. Individuals with disabilities from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds often face additional challenges when accessing support services.

SUPPORT PROGRAMS
& ORGANIZATIONS

Australian government's disability **support programs** like NDIS and job training have **limitations** in effectively covering the daily lives and career needs of people with disabilities. Some disability service organizations have been criticized for using a significant portion of government funding for their **own profits**. Moreover, the application process of disability pensions is **complex and time-consuming** for people with disabilities, and now is harder to apply than before. Existing job training programs should be more flexible to accommodate the varying work capacities of people with disabilities. The government also lacks comprehensive outreach and **publicity** for disabled support programs.

MENTAL HEALTH

A positive attitude can be particularly beneficial for people with disabilities, who may face unique challenges that can lead to mental health issues, helping them to build resilience and confidence on their abilities. **Social connections and advocacy** are important for people with disabilities. With confidence and social linkage, people with disabilities can better find and enjoy their careers.

	Original assumptions from background research	Interview findings from user insights
	 It's hard to find a job for people with disabilities than those who without disabilities in Australia.	Due to discrimination, the limitation of support programs, and mental health risks, many PWD in AU still face employment issue.
	 The combined assistance from the government and various organizations supports disabled people well.	Some PWD still have trouble accessing the help. Gov. support is not comprehensive and is complex to apply, while some org. are ' money grabs '.
	 Cultural and linguistic barriers could be a challenge for people with disabilities in AU from other countries.	PWD from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds often face more challenges to receive support.
	 People with disabilities in Australia still suffer from discriminations.	Discrimination still exists, especially for those who have hidden disabilities . But it's not common on physical disability.



LOGIC CHAIN

of user needs

BEFORE BEING EMPLOYED

they need easier access to support programs like NDIS and a fair career opportunity to help them get

EMPLOYED

and they need a more inclusive workplace in terms of attitude and accessibility

THROUGHOUT THE PROCESS

they need mental health support while multicultural disability group need special support

LATENT NEEDS

User Needs

Many disabled people that are able to work but not yet employed need an **easier access** to the disability support programs in Australia in this high inflation period.

“Man, now it’s harder to get government pensions than before.”

People with disabilities in Australia need a **fair career opportunity** and **more inclusive** work environment.

“Many people think I can’t do the job **simply because** I’m disabled.”

People with invisible disabilities need better public awareness for less discrimination, thereby providing broader career opportunities and enhancing mental health. Disabled people in Australia that not yet employed need more efficient and sufficient **financial support** and **career training** to better survive before and at work.

Most of disabled people in Australia with **multiple-culture background** need special support to overcome culture and language barriers.

“I feel it’s embarrassed to talk about my disability situation.”

Disabled people need **social linkage** and **emotional support** to reduce isolation and build confidence.

“I’m disheartened by not being employed and being isolated.”



User Issues

The **application process** for disability pensions is complex and time-consuming, particularly for those with diverse cultural and linguistic backgrounds.

“I can’t figure out those paperworks I need to submit.”

Many people with disabilities still suffers from **discrimination** from employers and the public.

“People are even afraid of talking to me, it’s ableism!”

Key User Groups

PEOPLE WITH DISABILITIES



Able to work but not yet employed



With multiple-culture background



With Hidden Disabilities



With Physical Disabilities

AGE / GENDER / LOCATION

18-65 / Any gender / in Australia

18-65 / Any gender / in Australia

18-65 / Any gender / in Australia

18-65 / Any gender / in Australia

DISABILITY TYPE

Any

Any

Hidden/invisible disability

Physical disability

CULTURAL & LANGUAGE

Any

Multiple culture background; Limited English proficiency

Any

Any

INCOME LEVEL

Low to moderate

Low to moderate

Any

Any

KEY IDENTIFIERS

May lack of career training; May have little access to disability support information

May have limited English proficiency; May come from cultures with different attitudes towards disability

Disability cannot be told from appearance; May not require visible assistive devices

Mobility impairments; May require assistive devices



Deniz Çetin



After a car accident, Deniz sustained physical injuries that now require a **wheelchair** for mobility. He used to enjoy a successful career as a restaurant chef but got the sack after the accident. Now he is trying to start his own travel agency in Tasmania to earn living cost and chasing the dream, and he still remains **passionate** on cooking.



FREELANCER | 35 | TAS
MOBILITY IMPAIRMENTS

GOALS

- To get support on **starting his own travel agency**
- To have a **larger house** for a better in-house mobility using wheelchair

FRUSTRATIONS

His disability hindered his movements, making it difficult for him to cook in the kitchen of the restaurant, which led to his **unemployment**. He also lacks of start-up capital for his own business.

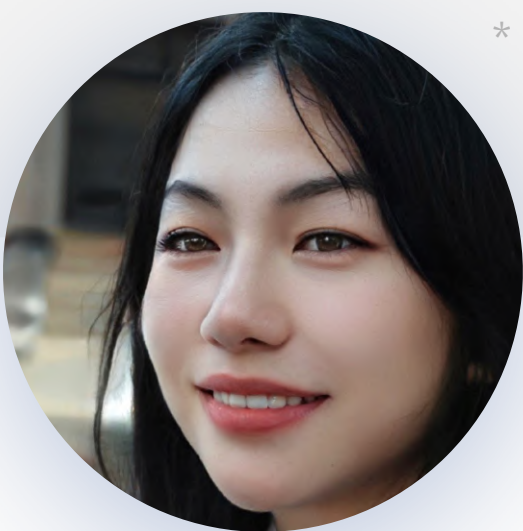
KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS

As a skilled chef, Deniz took pride in creating dishes delight the rich diversity of his patrons. But he's not proficient with electronic devices and **not good at English** as a non-native speaker.

Lisa Jung



Lisa is a recent graduate with a major in Digital Marketing and is currently **seeking for a job**. Although she requires medical care for her Tourette syndrome, it does not affect her work performance much. In addition to her professional interests, she is also passionate in makeup and dancing. But she's **not confident** in real life.



GRADUATE | 22 | SYD
TOURETTE SYNDROME

GOALS

- To get **sufficient pensions** especially before finding a job
- To work in an **inclusive** workplace without discrimination on hidden disability

FRUSTRATIONS

She frequently encounters disapproving looks and **ridicule** from others when she can't control herself and makes a sound, especially in the public spaces.

KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS

She is a bachelor's student who has **excelled academically**. She has a TikTok account sharing her daily life and is a **online social butterfly**.



* Portraits were generated by <https://this-person-does-not-exist.com/en>.



How might we increase job availability for disabled people in Australia during the high inflation period from a multicultural perspective?

Australia has now experiencing a high inflation era especially after the pandemic. This problem statement is rooted in the challenges faced by disabled people living in Australia, who are already vulnerable in the employment sector and are further affected by the current economic status, leading to a higher unemployment rates.

Government has developed support programs to increase their job opportunities to better cover their cost of living. However, in such a cultural diverse country, disabled individuals with **multicultural**

background still have **less accessibility** to those beneficial programs.

Our primary and secondary research showed that there are **executive issues** with the disability support programs and organizations, while low **public awareness** of disabilities leads to discrimination and exclusion of disabled individuals from job opportunities. Through interviews with potential users, their allies, and the public, we found that **employment is one of the important overlap points of the status quo of Australia and the needs of disabled people.**

REFLECTION ON DECISION PROCESS

How we take the further approach to apply multicultural perspective in this research

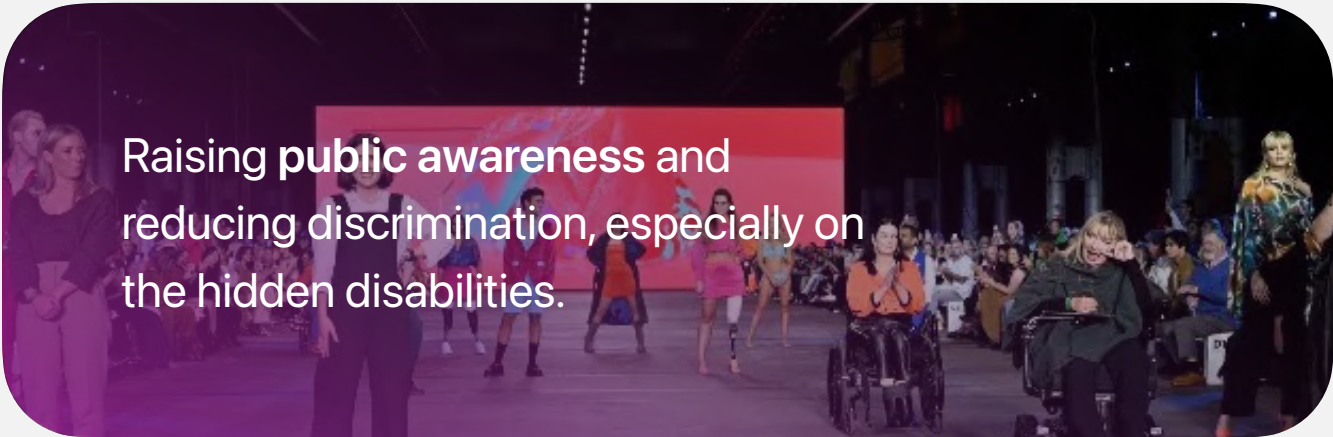
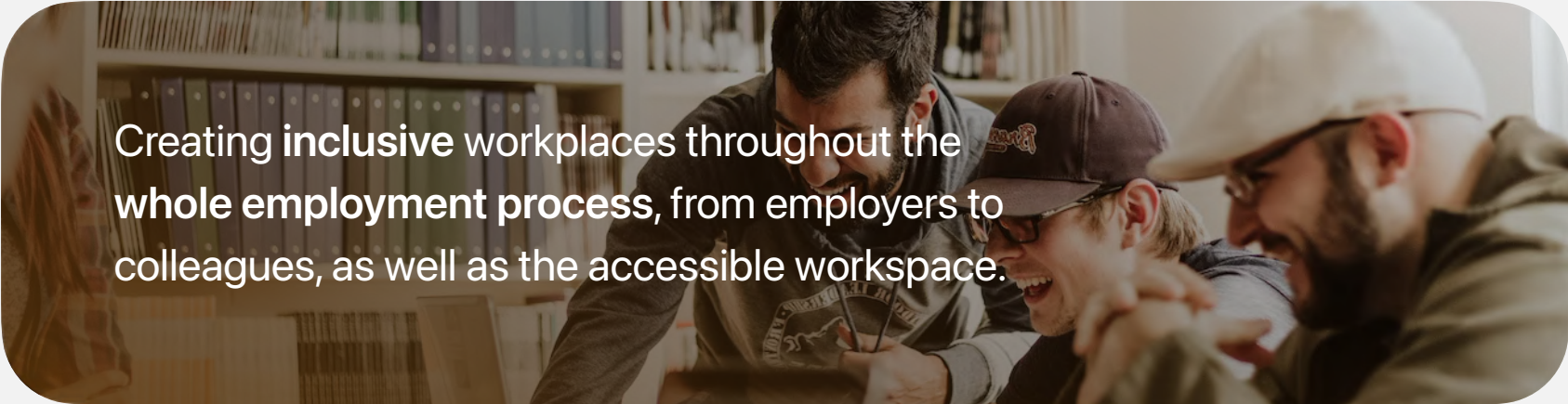
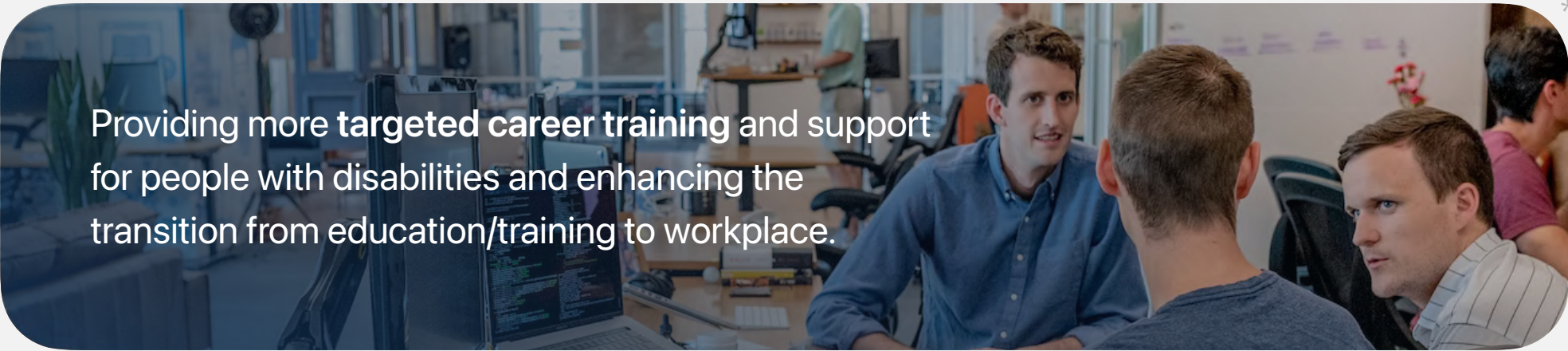
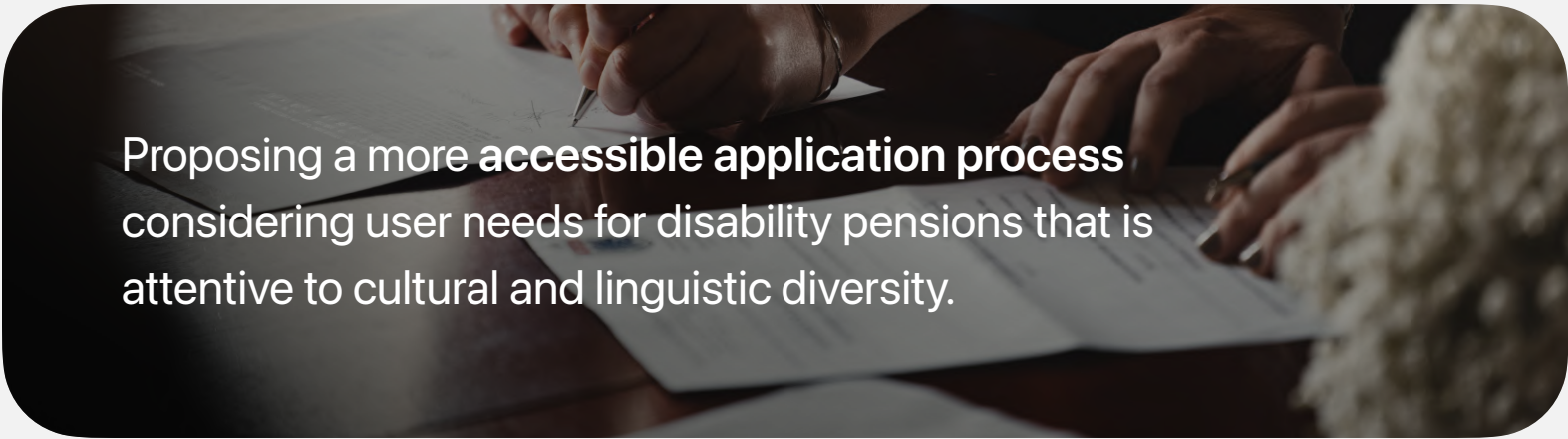
It's noteworthy that in the early stages of the project, we did not recognize the potential approach could be taken from a multicultural perspective in terms of job availability for people with disabilities in Australia.

However, after investigating government reports and statistics, as well as conducting a portion of interviews, we discovered that the **multicultural disability group is a significant population that deserves attention.** Not only are there a lack of research and currently pressing challenges for this group, but it was also frequently mentioned by our interviewees.





Leveraging the findings of background and user research and based on problem framing, we have explored several potential design opportunities for the future planning.



What's next

- Do more surveys and research to get in-depth user needs
- Synthesize the insights and identify specific potential solutions
- Conduct further research and prioritize design opportunities
- Prototype and test, refine and iterate

* Image sources: (Dancer, 2020; Distel, 2019; Lugo, 2019; Preez, 2018; Hui-Miller, 2022)



After completing this research report, there are a few more things we would like to discuss...

Throughout the user research journey, the most valuable and interesting part for our team was the opportunity to communicate with disabled people and organizations that support them. Initially, we faced challenges in finding disabled individuals to participate in our research, but we eventually found that most of the people we spoke with online were willing to share their experiences and perspectives with us. It was heartening to see that they were eager to talk to people and share their stories, as they often have fewer opportunities to do so due to their disabilities. Additionally, they expressed a desire for greater awareness and understanding of their disabilities among the general public.

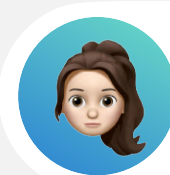
However, we also learned that disabled people can be sensitive to how they are treated in real life due to pressures and discrimination from society. This is why we faced rejection from some of the people we approached initially. Moving forward, we will be more aware of their feelings and choose to interact with them in a more gentle and sensitive way. We may also consider conducting interviews online from the outset to reduce any potential discomfort.

Overall, the user research experience was insightful and rewarding, as it allowed us to gain a deeper understanding of the challenges and opportunities for disabled people in the workforce. We believe that this knowledge will be invaluable as we move forward in developing potential solutions to address these issues.

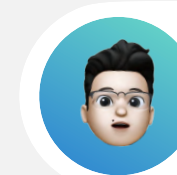
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Interview Details · Consent Letter

Appendix A

← Go back to [Interview · Data Collection](#) (P7)

Interview Consent Letter

Research topic:
How might we increase job availability for disabled people in Australia during the high inflation period?

Yes, as you can see,
when we first drafted
the consent letter,
we have not refine
our problem statement yet.

Dear participant,

Thank you for expressing interest in our short survey. We are postgraduate students at The University of Sydney, and this survey is designed for a user research report of an assignment. Our project is committed to providing equal employment opportunities and availability to all people with disabilities in order to relieve their living pressures.

Before we proceed with the interview process, we want to ensure that we have your consent to any accommodations you may require during the interview.

- This interview will be audio recorded as a supplement to the notes but will not be disclosed to anyone outside the project team, and will be destroyed when this semester ends.
- A transcript will be produced and analyzed by research investigators, but access to the transcript and report will be limited to research investigators and academic staff who might review and mark this project.
- All collected data is completely anonymous, and all your identity information, such as your name and workplace, will be protected and used only for this research report with no other purpose.
- We'll never use your personal information without your permission.

Your participation is voluntary, and you may choose to withdraw at any time without any consequences. You have the right to ask any questions or express any concerns before, during, or after the interview.

Thank you very much for your participation! We appreciate all your answers.

Sincerely,

Ultra HD Team
IDEA9106 Design Thinking
The University of Sydney

Interview Consent Letter

Research topic:

How might we increase job availability for disabled people in Australia during the high inflation period

Dear participant,

Thank you for expressing interest in our short survey. We are postgraduate students at The University of Sydney, and this survey is designed for a user research report of an assignment. Our project is committed to providing equal employment opportunities and availability to all people with disabilities in order to relieve their living pressures.

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Your participation is voluntary, and you may choose to withdraw at any time without any consequences. You have the right to ask any questions or express any concerns before, during, or after the interview.

Thank you very much for your participation! We appreciate all your answers.

Sincerely,

Ultra HD Team

IDEA9106 Design Thinking

The University of Sydney

Please sign below to indicate your consent to participate in the interview and for us to use the data collected for the research report.

Participant Signature

Date

19

Haiyan Gao hgao0237 · Entong Feng efen3913 · Yancheng Zhang yzha7774

Appendix B

← Go back to [Interview Participants \(P8\)](#)

01

DINESH
PALIPANA



- Born in Sri Lanka
- Doctor & Lawyer
- First quadriplegic medical graduate and intern in QLD
- Aussie of the Year 2021
- Order of Australia recipient
- Healthy Life AU Advisory Board



I came across your Wikipedia page and saw that you have worked as a doctor, lawyer, advocate, and fashion model. It's really impressive! Could you briefly share with us how you pursued your passions, especially as a person with quadriplegia?

Yeah, I grew up in Sri Lanka until I was the age of ten and then moved to Australia. I went to school in Australia and also high school, and I finished school and I didn't really know what I wanted to do, so I decided to study law. And so I was in law school and experienced depression when I was in law school. So then I started to see a doctor and I was just impressed by the doctor that treated me for depression. So I decided that I wanted to be a doctor as well. So I finished law, I graduated and then got into medical school and had a spinal cord injury while I was in medical school, which was a challenging journey. I spent about eight months in the hospital and then another three, four years rehabilitating and got back into medical school, graduated and then started work. So I'm in my 70 as a doctor now, but it's been a tricky journey because for someone with the spinal cord injury, medical school weren't that welcoming initially, but we managed to change all that and it was the same with the workplace. So it wasn't a straightforward journey, starting work as a doctor, but now it's great.

Could you be more specifically talk about how you overcome those challenges and difficulties during career journey?

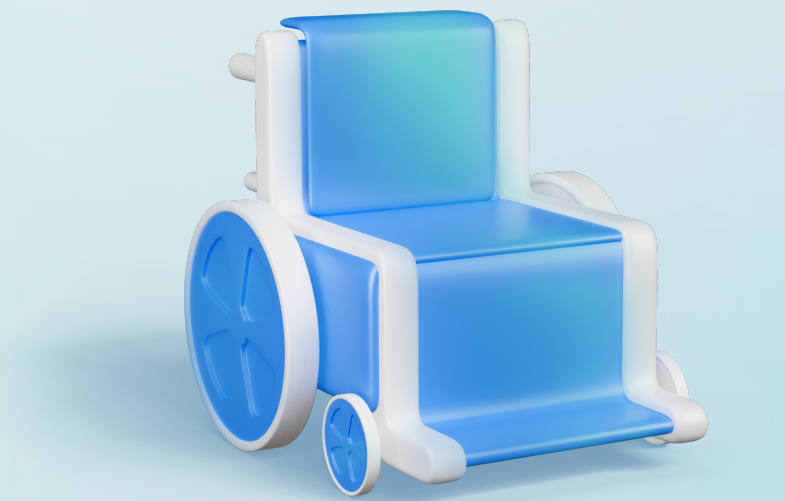
Well, getting back to medical school, there were a lot of people that said that I wouldn't be able to do medicine anymore, that I couldn't be a doctor if I had a spinal cord injury, I needed to use a wheelchair, but fortunately, I had enough supporters as well. So one of the biggest things was about having allies and supporters. So doctors and lecturers that were supportive in their journey. So I think that really helped. And then it was just about really working hard to try and get through the whole thing. So it wasn't easy, it wasn't an easy journey, but I think the main thing that made a difference was having people that were supportive and just not taking no for an answer and keeping going.

I have noticed that you mentioned in Job Access website that the application process for the EAF, which is Employment Assistance Fund, was easy. Could you briefly talk about the application steps?

Yeah, so that was done with the help of employment service provider and an occupational therapist and the hospital. So there have been a couple of times where if it was for equipment or other things, a combination of those people are really helpful. So what I had to do on my end was really minimal and having these professionals and the EAF at Job Access provide that support was really easy. So from a systems perspective, all those structures are there to help people with disability. It's more about making sure that people know about it and getting employees to understand all the things that they can provide. But the EAF process was really easy.

→ Continued on next page

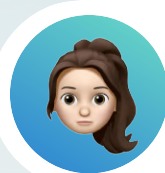
Made with jugs of Iced Americano ☕ and a heart that hopes to help people with disabilities 🦽
And thank you Rohan and Brandon 🙌



ultraHD group



Haiyan (Hailee) Gao
hgao0237



Entong (Colleen) Feng
efen3913



Yancheng (Eric) Zhang
yzha7774